“Śrī Caitanya-caritāmṛta”

Ādi-līlā

Chapter 9

The Wish-fulfilling Tree of Devotion

(translated from the Bengali for this edition)

1 I worship that glorious Lord, Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya, the guru of the world, by whose mercy even a dog can easily cross the great ocean.

2 All glory, all glory to Śrī Kṛṣṇa Caitanya Gauracandra! Glory, glory to Advaita! Glory, glory to Nityānanda!

3 Glory, glory to Gaura's devotees headed by Śrīvāsa, the remembrance of whom fulfills all desires!

4 Śrī Rūpa, Sanātana, Raghunātha Bhaṭṭa, Śrī Jīva, Gopāla Bhaṭṭa and Raghunātha dāsa —

5 by the grace of all these I write of Śrī Caitanya's pastimes and qualities. Whether I understand them or not, I write for my own purification.

6 I take shelter of Śrī Caitanya, who is Himself the gardener and Himself the immortal tree of love for Kṛṣṇa, and who both gives and enjoys its fruits.

7 The Lord said, “I bear the name Viśvambhara, ‘He who fills and sustains the universe.’ The name will be fulfilled only if I fill the universe with love.”

8 Thinking this, the Lord took up the gardener's role and in Navadvīpa began the work of an orchard.

9 Śrī Caitanya, the gardener, brought the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion (*bhakti-kalpataru*) to the earth and planted it, watering it with His own will.

10 Glory to Śrī Mādhava Purī, brimming with love for Kṛṣṇa! He is the first sprout of the wish-fulfilling tree of devotion.

11 In the form of Śrī Īśvara Purī the sprout grew strong, and Caitanya the gardener Himself appeared as the trunk.

12 By His own inconceivable energy the gardener also became the trunk, and that trunk is the root and support of all the branches.

13–15 Paramānanda Purī and Keśava Bhāratī, Brahmānanda Purī and Brahmānanda Bhāratī, Viṣṇu Purī, Keśava Purī, Kṛṣṇānanda Purī, Śrī Nṛsiṁha Tīrtha and Sukhānanda Purī — these nine roots sprang forth at the base of the tree, and on these nine roots the tree stood steady.

16 The central root is Paramānanda Purī, steady and wise. On these nine roots the tree stood firm.

17 Above the trunk many branches sprang forth, and higher and higher they grew beyond counting.

18 With twenty branches forming each cluster, the mighty branches covered the whole universe.

19 On each branch grew hundreds and hundreds of sub-branches. Who can count all the branches that grew?

20 I shall list the names of the principal branches later; now hear the description of the tree.

21 Above the branching, the tree became two trunks: one named Advaita, the other Nityānanda.

22 From those two trunks grew many branches, and their sub-branches covered the world.

23 Great branches, sub-branches and their sub-branches pervaded the world. Who could write them all down?

24 Disciples, disciples of disciples and their followers have pervaded the world; there is no counting them.

25 As the udumbara fig bears fruit on every part, so fruit appears everywhere on the tree of devotion.

26 The fruit of love that grew on the branches and sub-branches of the main trunk surpasses nectar.

27 When the fruits of love ripened, sweet as nectar, Caitanya the gardener distributed them without taking any price.

28 All the wealth and jewels in the three worlds I do not reckon as the price of a single fruit.

29 Whether one asks or not, whether one is worthy or unworthy, He knows no such consideration; He simply gives.

30 Filling His cupped hands again and again, He throws the fruits in all four directions. The poor gather them and eat, and the gardener smiles.

31 The gardener said, “Listen, family of the tree, all you main branches and sub-branches of every kind!

32 This extraordinary tree performs the work of all the senses: though stationary, it has the nature of moving beings.

33 All the parts of this tree are conscious, and as they grow, they spread through all the worlds.

34 I am the only gardener. How many places can I go? How many fruits can I pick and distribute alone?

35 It is hard work to pick them up and give them out alone, and I am left uncertain: some may receive them, and some may not.

36 Therefore I give all of you this order: give the fruit of love anywhere and everywhere, to anyone and everyone.

37 I am the only gardener. How many fruits can I eat? And if I do not give this fruit away, what else would I do with it?

38 I water the tree constantly with the nectar of My own will, and so countless fruits grow upon it.

39 Therefore give all the fruits to anyone and everyone. Let people eat them and become free from old age and death.

40 Then My holy fame will pervade the world, and people, made happy, will sing My glory.

41 One who has taken human birth in the land of Bhārata should make his birth fruitful by working for the welfare of others.

42 “This is the fulfillment of birth for embodied beings in this world: always to act for the true good of others with one's life, wealth, intelligence and words.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.22.35)

43 “By deed, mind and word, an intelligent person should do only what serves the welfare of living beings in this world and the next.” (Viṣṇu Purāṇa 3.12.45)

44 I am only a gardener; I have no kingdom or wealth. By giving fruits and flowers I earn merit (*puṇya*).

45 Though I am the gardener, I have also become the tree, with this very wish: that all living beings may benefit from the tree.

46 “Oh, how excellent is the birth of these trees, which sustain all living beings! Like a good-hearted man, they never send away disappointed anyone who comes to them in need.” (Śrīmad-Bhāgavatam 10.22.33)”

47 When Caitanya the gardener gave this order, the family of the tree felt supreme joy.

48 Each of them gave away the fruit of love here and there, and by tasting the fruit all people became intoxicated.

49 People ate their fill of the highly intoxicating fruit of love, and everyone became maddened: they laugh, dance and sing.

50 Some roll on the ground, some roar; seeing this, the gardener smiles with delight.

51 This gardener Himself eats this fruit of love and remains always intoxicated, helpless and overwhelmed.

52 He made everyone as intoxicated as Himself; I see no one but people maddened with love.

53 Those who earlier had criticized Him, calling Him a drunkard, now eat the fruit, dance and say, “Wonderful, wonderful!”

54 Thus I have told of the distribution of the fruit of love. Now hear which branches give the fruit.

55 Praying at the feet of Śrī Rūpa and Raghunātha, I, Kṛṣṇadāsa, tell the *Caitanya-caritāmṛta*.